



TRIP OFFER

Peaks of the Balkans

10-day guided trek

A full crossing of Albania, Kosovo and Montenegro on shepherd paths through the Accursed Mountains—up to 2,300 m, wild, remote and unforgettable.

DURATION

10 days

DISTANCE

192 km

LEVEL

Moderate +

FROM

€1,300

More than a route. A way into the mountains.

Few routes show the Western Balkans the way this one does. Over ten guided days you follow old footpaths through high alpine country, linking remote valleys where landscape and living culture still sit side by side.

The Peaks of the Balkans is a roughly 192 km cross-border trail across the Accursed Mountains of Albania, Kosovo and Montenegro. For decades these ridges were tightly controlled; today they form one of Europe's most compelling long walks—open, wild and increasingly sought after.

Expect terrain that moves between easier stretches and steeper mountain days. A solid fitness base and proper hiking kit are essential. This is a classic for anyone who wants a serious multi-day trek with local guides and village hospitality throughout.

BEST SEASON

June – October

COUNTRIES

Albania · Kosovo · Montenegro

WHAT STAYS WITH YOU

01 Three countries on one continuous trail

02 Passes and ridges above 2,000 metres



Your journey, unfolded.

DAY 01

Shkodër → Theth

Meet the group, drive into the Albanian Alps and settle into Theth.

Gather with your guide in Shkodër—one of Albania's oldest cities—then head toward Theth through the Boga Valley, the natural doorway into the Albanian Alps. We pause at Qafë Thorë for wide mountain views before the zig-zag descent to a village guesthouse and a homemade dinner. Later, a short stroll introduces you to Theth National Park. Transfers from Tirana or Podgorica can be arranged on request.

Drive ~2h 20 · Dinner · Guesthouse

- Accommodation: Guesthouse
- Meals: Dinner
- Drive: up to 2h 20min

DAY 02

Theth → Valbonë

Cross Valbona Pass and descend into one of Albania's great valleys.

The path climbs steadily toward Valbona Pass (about 1,792 m)—a rewarding mountain day that many first-time alpine walkers complete with care and pacing. From the saddle, the Albanian Alps and Valbona Valley open below. After lunch we descend into the valley; you can finish on the wide dry riverbed on foot or shorten the last stretch with a van.

~16 km · 6–7h · Moderate / Challenging

- Trail ~16 km · Ascent/descent ~1,050 m / 800 m · Max ~1,760 m
- Difficulty: Moderate / Challenging
- Meals: Breakfast, picnic lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

DAY 03

Valbonë → Çerem

Climb Prejlslopi Pass, touch Montenegro, then drop to Çerem.

After breakfast and mountain tea we ascend switchbacks to Prejlslopi Pass (~2,000 m), with snow-touched peaks in every direction. A short, rocky stretch after the pass needs careful footing—poles help, especially if the stones are wet. We note the old border stone, re-enter Albania and ease down through meadows and beech forest to Çerem. In stormy weather we skip this high section and transfer by 4x4 (~30 min) to the guesthouse.

~14 km · 7–8h · Moderate / Challenging

- Trail ~14 km · Ascent/descent ~1,150 m / 870 m · Max ~2,040 m
- Difficulty: Moderate / Challenging
- Meals: Breakfast, picnic lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

DAY 04

Çerem → Dobërdol

Forest ups and downs into the wide alpine pastures of Dobërdol.

Leaving Çerem and the Kollata massif, we walk for hours through forest with frequent rises and dips. The route briefly crosses into Montenegro and back past the ruins of an old military border post. Lunch is at Balqin, a seasonal shepherd hamlet, before a calmer, scenic approach through patches of beech to the open pastures of Dobërdol.

~16 km · 6–7h · Moderate

- Trail ~16 km · Ascent/descent ~1,025 m / 440 m · Max ~1,920 m
- Difficulty: Moderate
- Meals: Breakfast, picnic lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

DAY 05

Dobërdol → Milishevc

Reach the triple border and walk into Kosovo's shepherd country.

An early start takes us across bilberry meadows toward the ridge where Albania, Kosovo and Montenegro meet. The high point near Triple Peak (~2,266 m) looks back over the Albanian Alps you have already walked. From there, alpine meadows lead toward Milishevc in Kosovo. Exact distance can vary slightly with the guesthouse we use.

~18 km · 6–7h · Moderate

- Trail ~18 km · Ascent/descent ~950 m · Max ~2,236 m
- Difficulty: Moderate
- Meals: Breakfast, picnic lunch, dinner · Guesthouse
- Note: luggage transport not included on this day

DAY 06

Milishevc → Babino Polje

Cross from Kosovo into Montenegro on a scenic border day.

After breakfast we follow a shorter but richly varied trail into Montenegro. Colourful mountain terrain makes the hours pass easily before a gradual descent into Babino Polje, with time to enjoy the views along the way.

~16 km · 5–6h · Easy / Moderate

- Trail ~16 km · Ascent/descent ~700 m / 880 m · Max ~2,166 m
- Difficulty: Easy / Moderate
- Meals: Breakfast, picnic lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

DAY 07

Babino Polje → Plav

Swim at Hrid Lake, then continue toward the town of Plav.

We hike to quiet Hrid Lake for a cool forest swim and rest, then climb to a viewpoint and picnic in the Treskavica meadows. The last stretch follows a dirt road and can be shortened with a ~30-minute transfer from Treskavica, cutting roughly 6–7 km. Plav is the largest settlement on the route, with shops, ATMs and pharmacies if you need them.

~21 km · 7–8h · Moderate

- Trail ~21 km · Ascent/descent ~600 m / 1,190 m · Max ~2,236 m
- Difficulty: Moderate
- Meals: Breakfast, picnic lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

DAY 08

Toward Vusanje via Bori

Forest, ridge and Bori Peak views before arriving in Vusanje.

Beech forest and flowering meadows lead onto the open Bori ridge. A steep final ramp reaches Bori Peak (~2,106 m), where the Accursed Mountains spread in every direction. We descend through meadow and forest to Vusanje for two nights in Montenegro. A short 4x4 link (~40 min) supports the day's logistics.

~17 km · 6–7h · Moderate

- Trail ~17 km · Ascent/descent ~740 m / 1,170 m · Max ~2,100 m
- Difficulty: Moderate · Drive: ~40 min 4x4
- Meals: Breakfast, picnic lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

DAY 09

Grebaja · Vajusha day hike

A summit day in Grebaja National Park, then return to Vusanje.

After breakfast we transfer to Grebaja Valley and climb through forest toward Vallushnica Peak, then along the ridge to Taljanka (~2,056 m) for a picnic with big views. We descend to the valley and transfer back to Vusanje. About 40 minutes of driving each way.

~10 km · 5–6h · Moderate / Challenging

- Trail ~10 km · Ascent/descent ~1,020 m · Max ~2,056 m
- Difficulty: Moderate / Challenging · Drive: ~40 min each way
- Meals: Breakfast, picnic lunch, dinner · Guesthouse

DAY 10

Vusanje → Theth · Shkodër

A final border hike into Theth, then transfer back to Shkodër.

A short 4x4 ride into Ropojana Valley starts the last trail day: a memorable crossing from Montenegro into Albania through Prokletije / Bjeshkët e Namuna. Steep limestone walls frame much of the walk; old border markers, bunkers and a pyramid sign still hint at the closed past. Picnic among alpine flowers, then a careful scree descent from Peja Pass toward Okol. After the hike we transfer to Shkodër (up to ~2 hours).

~17 km · 6–7h · Moderate

- Trail ~17 km · Ascent/descent ~780 m / 1,000 m · Max ~1,435 m
- Difficulty: Moderate · Meals: Breakfast, picnic lunch
- Drive to Shkodër: up to ~2h

What's covered. What's not.

INCLUDED

- ✓ English-speaking local guide
- ✓ Group transfers from and to Shkodër
- ✓ All guesthouse stays during the trek
- ✓ All meals on trek as shown in the itinerary
- ✓ Hut-to-hut luggage transport (except day 5)
- ✓ All land transport required by the itinerary
- ✓ Border permits and national park fees

NOT INCLUDED

- Hotels before or after the trek
- Alcoholic drinks and soft drinks
- Personal expenses and shopping
- Tips for guide and local staff
- Transport beyond the itinerary
- Flights and travel insurance

ON THE TRAIL



Gear for the trail.

REQUIRED

- Sturdy hiking shoes or boots
- Trekking poles
- Daypack (30 L+)
- Sun hat, sunglasses, sunscreen, swimwear
- Waterproof jacket and rain trousers
- Warm fleece or mid-layer
- Fleece hat and gloves (June & Sept–Oct)
- Lightweight long-sleeve shirts
- Trekking trousers
- Personal hygiene kit / sanitiser
- Small personal first-aid kit and medicines
- Two 1-litre water bottles
- Insect repellent
- Earplugs
- Trail snacks
- Soft duffel for luggage transfers
- Peaks of the Balkans app (offline maps)

OPTIONAL

- Headlamp or torch
- Shorts, trainers, sandals, bandana
- Camera and spare batteries
- Liner socks
- Town shoes and casual clothes
- Spare laces, luggage tags and locks
- Small knife / whistle
- Water purification tablets
- Reading material, binoculars
- Lunch box and mug

BEFORE YOU GO

Travel documents

Valid passport with at least six months remaining validity.

Money

Albania uses the lek (ALL); euros are widely accepted. Kosovo and Montenegro use the euro. Lek is typically only available inside Albania.

ATMs

Reliable options in Tirana and Shkodër; also Gusinje and Plav on the Montenegrin side.

Time & power

GMT+1. Electricity is 220 V / 50 Hz with two-pin round plugs.

Visas

Most travellers (including UK, many EU, US, Canada, Australia, New Zealand) do not need a visa for Albania or Kosovo. Check current Montenegro entry rules for your nationality.

Health

No special vaccinations are required for Kosovo, Albania or Montenegro for most visitors—bring personal medication and travel insurance.

Support

Call or WhatsApp +383 49 601 007. Phone: Mon–Fri 08:00–20:00, Sat–Sun 14:00–17:00 (CET). Chat support runs longer into the evening.

Questions before you book.

Where do I join the tour, and which airport should I use?

We confirm the exact meeting point and time before departure. You can fly into Tirana, Podgorica, Pristina or Skopje. Arrivals via Pristina or Skopje usually start and finish in Pristina; Tirana or Podgorica arrivals start and finish in Shkodër, with onward transfers available after the trek.

How large is the group?

Open group dates run with a minimum of 4 and a maximum of 7 guests. At 4 confirmed travellers we guarantee departure. Private groups for friends or family can range from 2 to 12.

What is included in the trip price?

Listed prices are for the tour only (flights separate). Inclusions and exclusions are detailed in the Holiday Information section—typically lodging, trek meals, itinerary transport, park fees and border permits.

Can I have a single room?

Village lodging is limited, so single rooms are not always available. Most nights are twin or triple share. Solo travellers on open groups share with someone of the same gender when a single cannot be arranged.

What if I need to cancel or transfer my booking?

Please write to us as soon as you know. Cancellation charges follow our booking conditions; we will confirm what applies to your dates.

Is there an age limit?

There is no upper age limit. Travellers aged 80 or over may be asked a few fitness questions so we can confirm the itinerary suits you. On group departures the minimum age is 16; under-16s must travel with a parent or accompanying adult.

Can I add nights before or after the trek?

Yes. Extra nights at our usual start or end hotels are easy to arrange—mention it when you book and we will sort the details with you.



BALKAN PEAKS ADV

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Pejë, Kosovo

Offer · 10-day guided trek · From €1,300 · Group 4–7 guests

Prices are for the tour only. Flights and travel insurance are separate.

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